ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 20

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Santali Alphabet

ᱚᱞ ᱪᱤᱠᱤᱫ ᱚᱨ ᱯᱟᱹᱹᱨᱥᱤ ᱪᱤᱞᱚᱣᱟ

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 30 Santali Letters with English Phonetics



Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Santali Alphabet — ᱥᱟᱱᱛᱟᱞᱤ ᱚᱞᱪᱤᱠᱤ ᱚᱨ ᱫᱟᱠᱟ ᱚᱞᱚᱱᱟ
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 20

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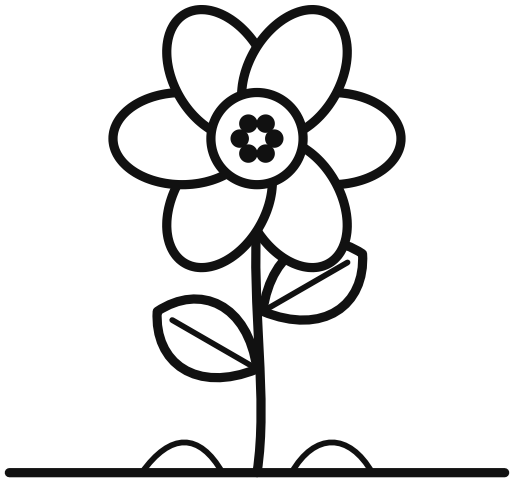
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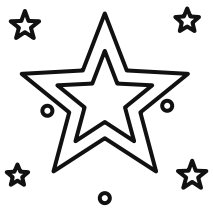
A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



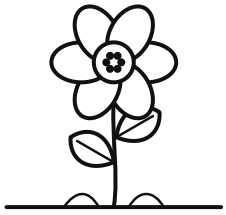
This book belongs to

ᱫᱚᱦᱚ ᱨᱮᱭᱟᱜ ᱫᱚ ... ᱵᱟᱞᱚᱜ

I started learning Santali on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 20 is Santali. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **aw** is the Ol Chiki vowel ᱚ, like "aw" in "law" but short. **ah** is ᱟ, as in "father".
- **CAPITALS** show the part of the word to say a little louder: *BAH-hah*.
- Some sounds are made with the **tongue curled back** (ᱜ ᱡ ᱢ ᱣ). The guide writes them as plain t, d, n, r; the letter page tells you to curl your tongue.
- At the end of a word ᱜ ᱣ ᱥ ᱡ are **"caught" sounds** (k', ch', t', p'): close your mouth for the sound, but let no air out.
- **kh, th, dh** mean the letter plus a puff of air (the letter ᱲ), not the English "th".

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Santali name** written in Santali (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Ol Chiki name · its row* shows the name Santali children use for the letter (ᱚ is «aak», ᱛ is «aam»…) and the row of five it belongs to.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Santali as written in Ol Chiki in Jharkhand and West Bengal.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Santali! ᱚᱞᱪᱤᱠᱤ

SAHN-tah-ree — the Santali word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **7½ million people** speak Santali.[3] It is one of the 22 languages listed in India's Constitution.

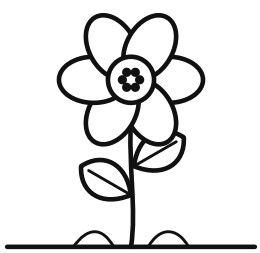
Where?
In eastern **India** (Jharkhand, West Bengal, Odisha, Bihar and Assam), and also in **Bangladesh** and **Nepal**.

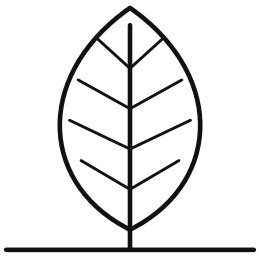
How is it written?
In its own alphabet, **Ol Chiki** ᱚᱞ ᱪᱤᱠᱤ, from **left to right**. Some people also write Santali in Bengali, Odia or Latin letters.

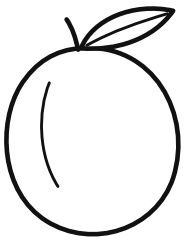
How many letters?
30 letters in six rows of five, plus its own **numbers** ᱐ ᱑ ᱒ ᱓…

Hello!
Santali speakers greet each other with ᱡᱚᱣᱟᱦᱟᱨ *JAW-hahr*.

Did you know?
Santali belongs to the **Munda** family of languages, a different family from Hindi or Bengali. Many Santali words are short and sweet: ᱣᱞ *ool* is a mango and ᱫᱟᱜ *dahk* is water.





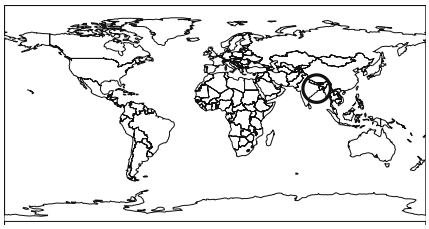


The Santali Alphabet ᱚᱯ ᱫᱟᱲᱟ

30 letters in six rows — ᱚᱯ ᱫᱟᱲᱟ

ᱚ *law*	ᱛ *awt*	ᱜ *awg*	ᱝ *awng*	ᱞ *awl*
ᱟ *lah*	ᱠ *ahk*	ᱡ *ahj*	ᱢ *ahm*	ᱣ *ahw*
ᱤ *lee*	ᱮ *ees*	ᱷ *eeh*	ᱰ *eeny*	ᱵ *eer*
ᱩ *loo*	ᱪ *ooch*	ᱫ *ood*	ᱱ *oon*	ᱸ *ooy*
ᱷ *leh*	ᱯ *ehp*	ᱰ *ehd*	ᱧ *ehn*	ᱨ *ehr*
ᱳ *loh*	ᱦ *oht*	ᱵ *ohb*	ᱣ *ohw*	ᱷ *ohh*

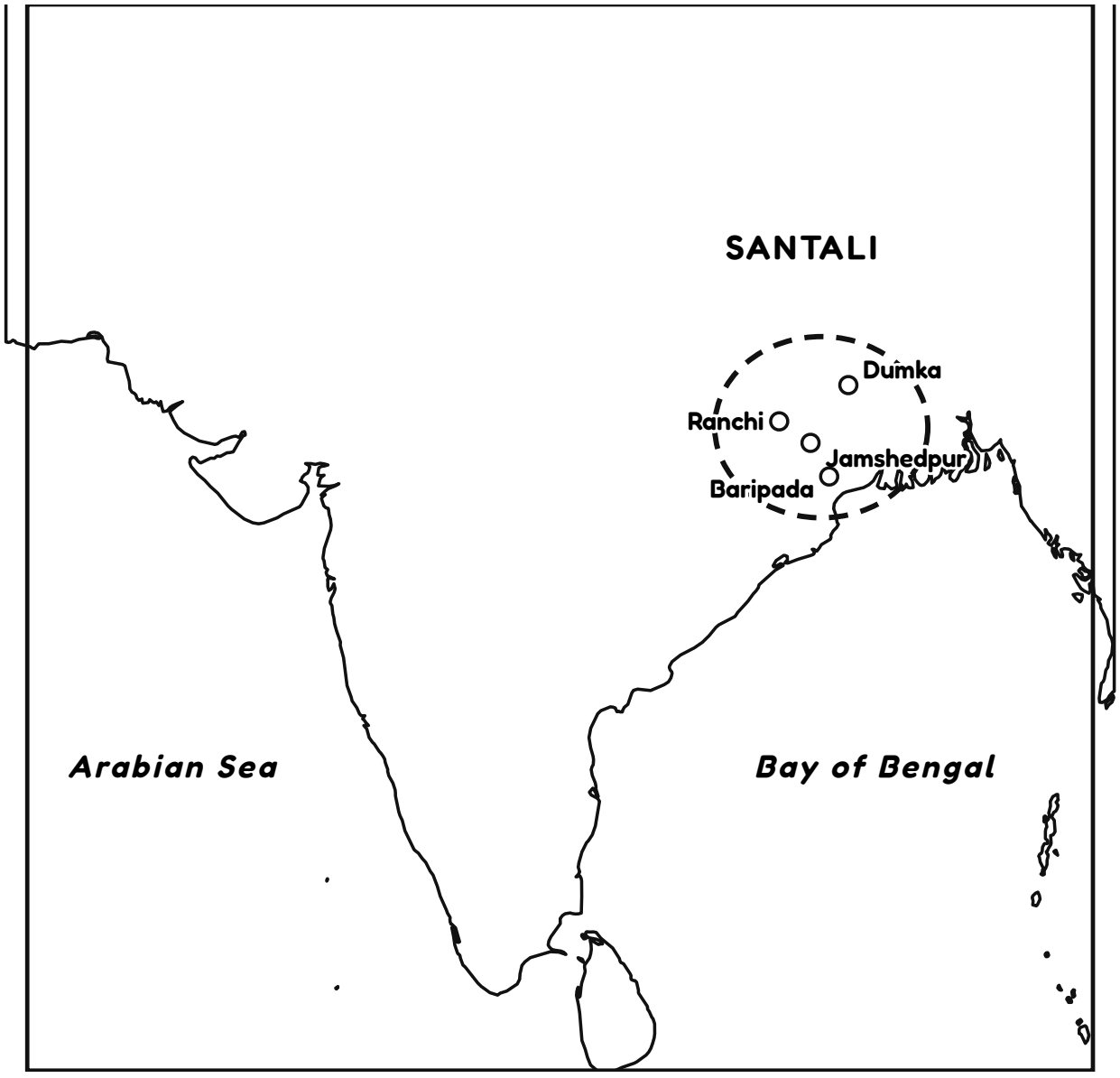
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows the Santali-speaking area on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Santali spoken?



Color it: the area inside the dashed line **yellow** · the rest of the land **green** · the seas **blue**. **Find it:** Santali is spoken around Ranchi, Jamshedpur and Dumka in Jharkhand, in West Bengal, and around Baripada in Odisha.

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THE LETTERS

The Letters ᱚᱞ ᱪᱤᱠᱤ

awl CHEE-kee — “the writing letters”

Santali is written in **Ol Chiki** ᱚᱞ ᱪᱤᱠᱤ, an alphabet made just for Santali by **Pandit Raghunath Murmu** in 1925. It has **30 letters**, and it is written from left to right.

Six rows of five

Children learn Ol Chiki in **six rows**. Each row begins with a vowel:

ᱚ ᱛ ᱜ ᱝ ᱞ

ᱡ ᱟ ᱣ ᱤ ᱩ

ᱨ ᱮ ᱲ ᱳ ᱴ

ᱵ ᱶ ᱷ ᱸ ᱹ

ᱻ ᱼ ᱽ ᱾ ᱿

ᲀ ᲁ ᲂ ᲃ ᲄ

Letters that say their names

Every letter has a short name, and the name holds the letter’s sound: ᱟ is «aak», ᱤ is «aam». The six vowels ᱚ ᱡ ᱨ ᱵ ᱻ ᲀ are called «la, laa, li, lu, le, lo».

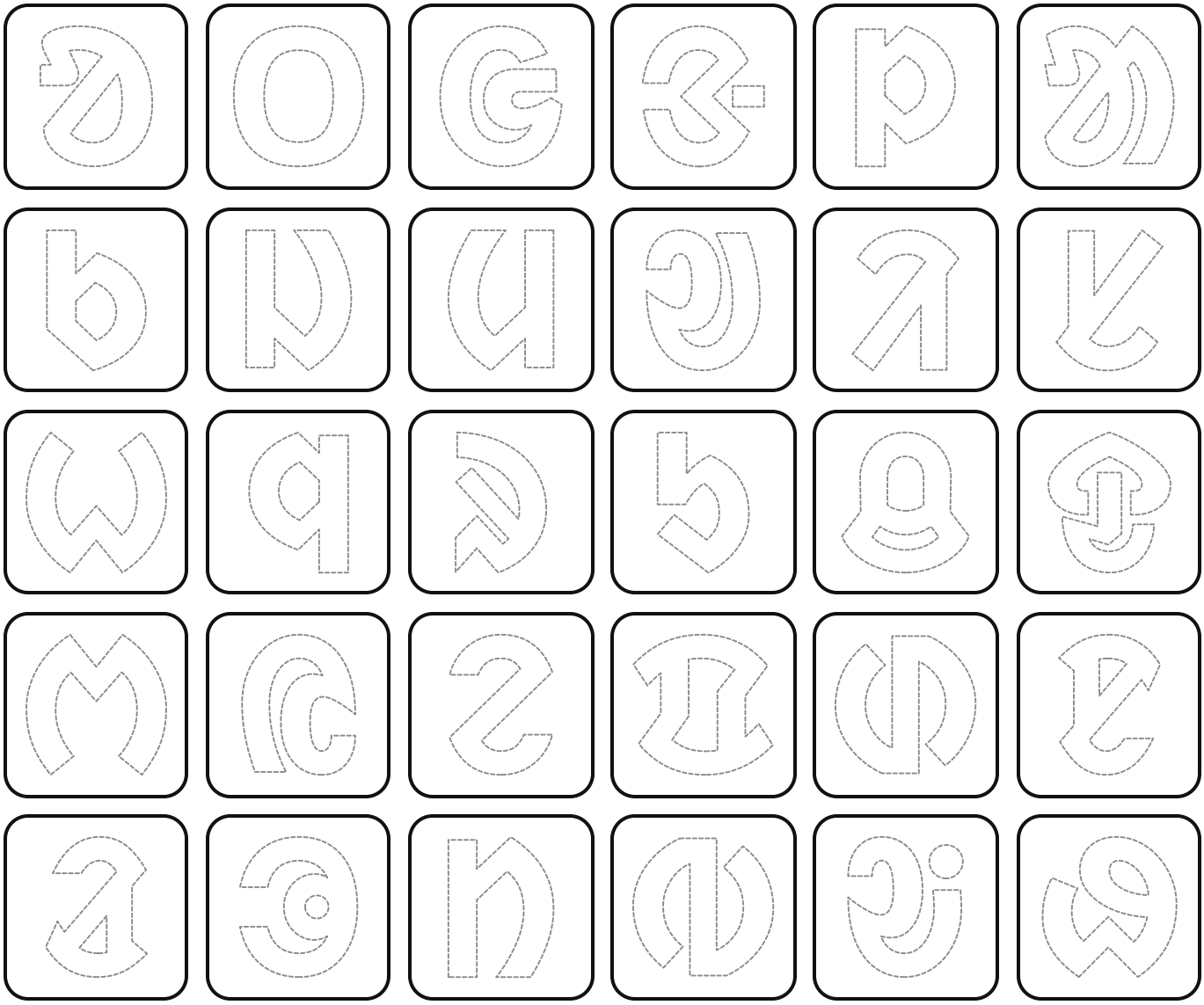
Full letters, no vowel signs

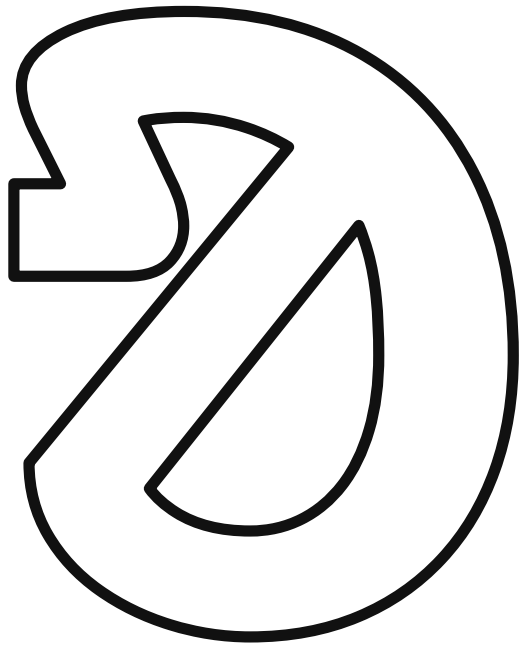
In Ol Chiki every vowel is written as a full letter, one after another: ᱫ + ᱡ + ᱜ = ᱫᱡᱜ «dahk», “water”.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters 𐤀𐤐 𐤔𐤓𐤁𐤓

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · ᱯᱚᱞᱟ

ᱯᱚ

law

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

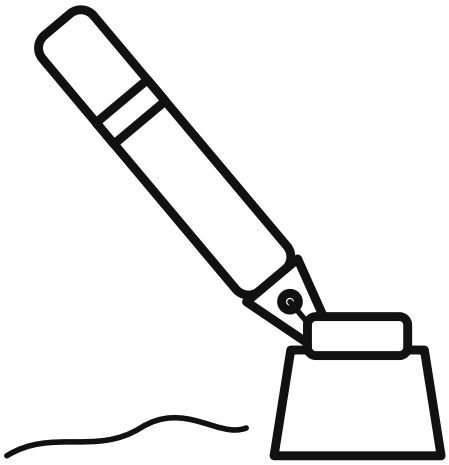
‘aw’ as in “law” (short)

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱚ — ᱯᱚ

Its name is «la». Row 1: ᱚ ᱳ ᱴ ᱶ ᱯ

The word ᱚᱯ gives the script its name: ᱚᱯ ᱚᱞᱪᱤᱠᱤ «Ol Chiki».



ᱚ IS FOR

ᱚᱯ

awl

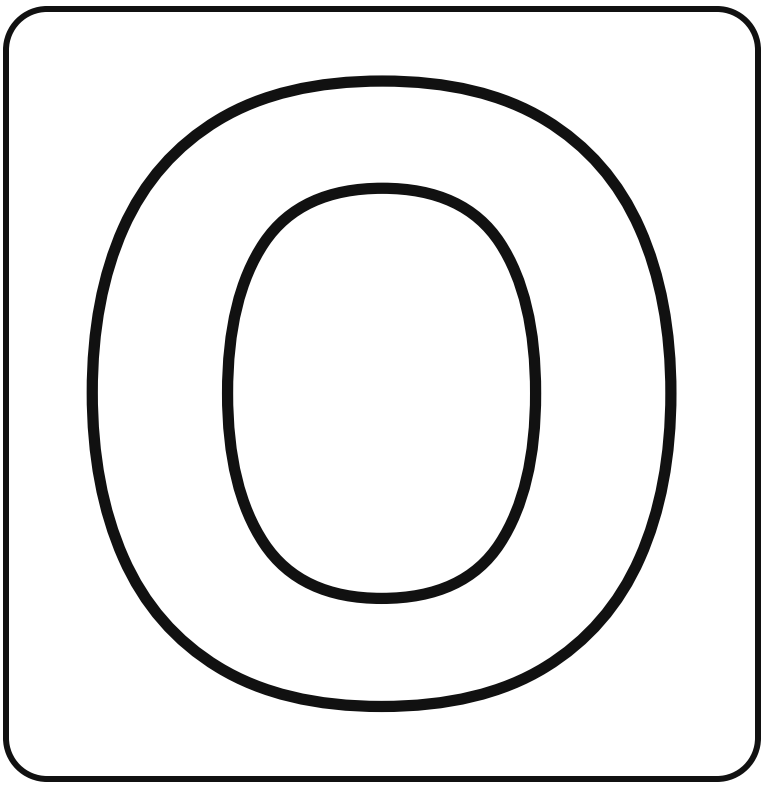
writing

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱩᱸ



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NAME · ᱫᱚᱫᱩ

ᱚO

awt

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

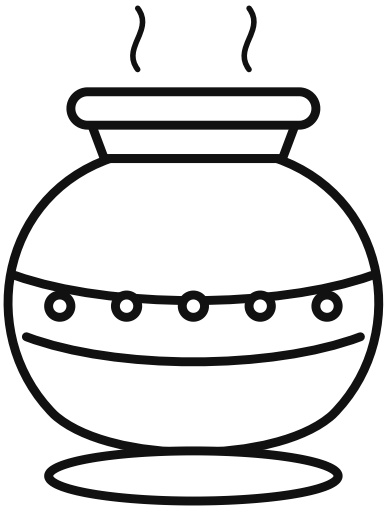
‘t’ as in “top”, with the tongue on the teeth

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

O — ᱚO

Its name is «at». Row 1: ᱚ O ᱜ ᱝ ᱯ

At the end of a word O is a “caught” sound: the mouth closes but no air comes out (ᱢᱤᱫ mit’ “one”).



O IS FOR

Oᱦᱦᱫ

TOO-kooch

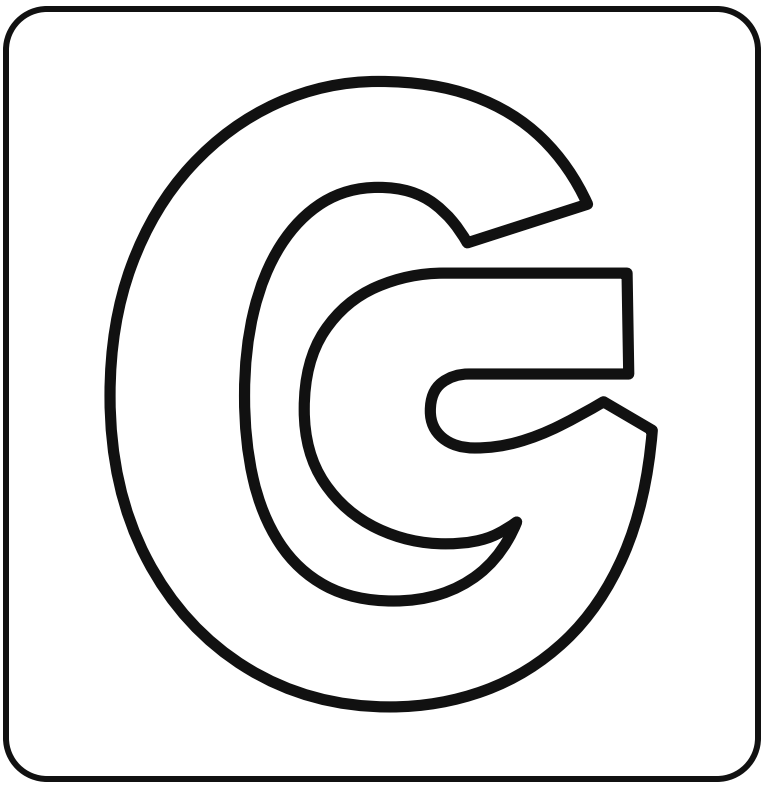
clay pot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱩᱸ

O O O O

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NAME · ᱟᱣᱜᱩ

ᱚᱜ

awg

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

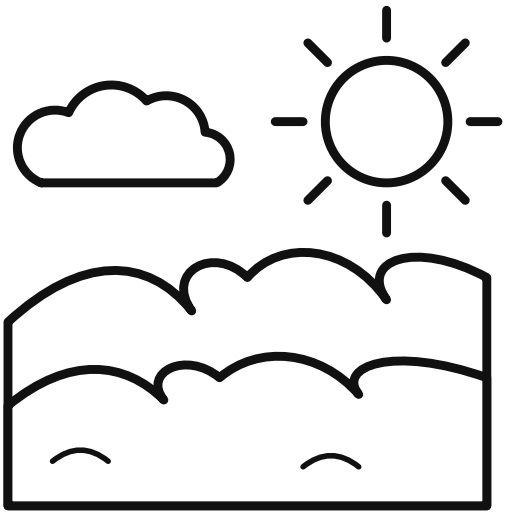
‘g’ as in “go”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱜ — ᱚᱜ

Its name is «ag». Row 1: ᱚ ᱳ ᱜ ᱝ ᱯ

At the end of a word ᱜ is a “caught” sound: the mouth closes but no air comes out (ᱫᱚᱜ dahk’ “water”).



ᱜ IS FOR

ᱜᱟᱦᱚ

GAH-dah

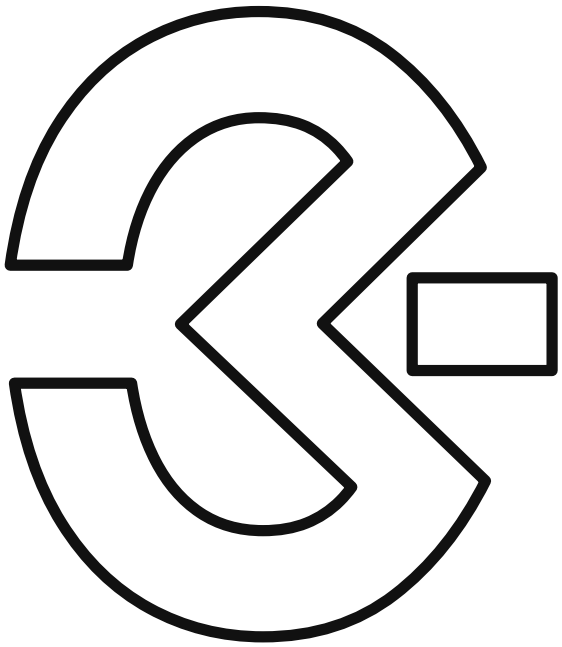
river

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱩᱨ

ᱜ ᱜ ᱜ ᱜ

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NAME · ᱟᱣᱱᱜ

ᱚᱜ

awng

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

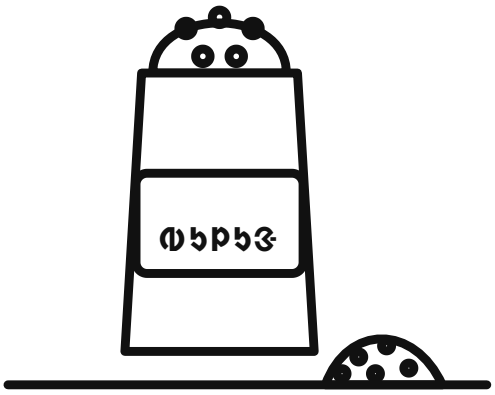
‘ng’ as in “sing”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱜ — ᱚᱜ

Its name is «ang». Row 1: ᱚ ᱳ ᱩ ᱜ ᱯ

ᱜ rarely starts a word. Find it at the end of ᱚᱵᱯᱵᱜ!



ᱜ IS FOR

ᱚᱵᱯᱵᱜ

BOO-loong

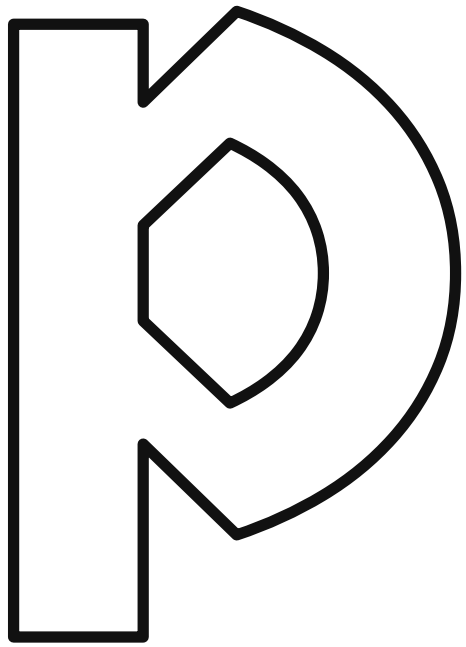
salt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱩᱨ

ᱜ ᱜ ᱜ ᱜ

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NAME · ᱚᱞᱚᱪᱩ

ᱚᱯ

awl

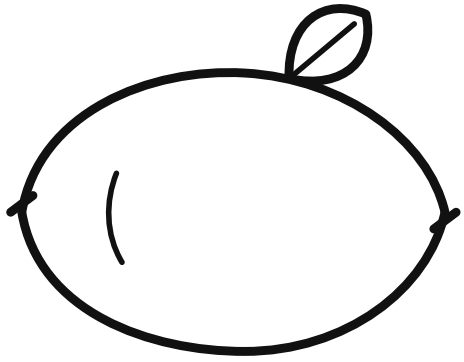
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱯ — ᱚᱯ

Its name is «al». Row 1: ᱚ ᱳ ᱜ ᱝ ᱯ



ᱯ IS FOR

ᱯᱨᱩᱢᱩᱵ

LEEM-boo

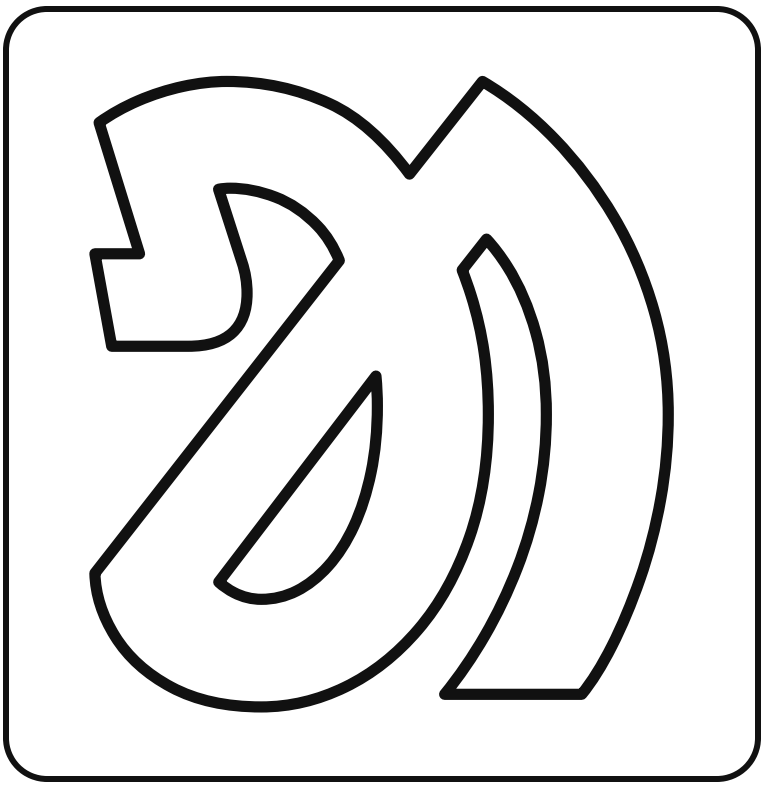
lemon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱩᱨ

ᱯ ᱯ ᱯ ᱯ

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NAME · ᱞᱟᱦᱟ

ᱹ᱾

lah

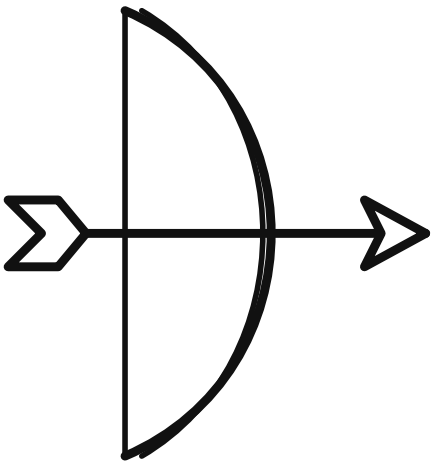
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ah’ as in “father”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

᱾ — ᱹ᱾

Its name is «laa». Row 2: ᱾ ᱦ ᱲ ᱳ ᱶ



᱾ IS FOR

᱾ᱜ

ahk

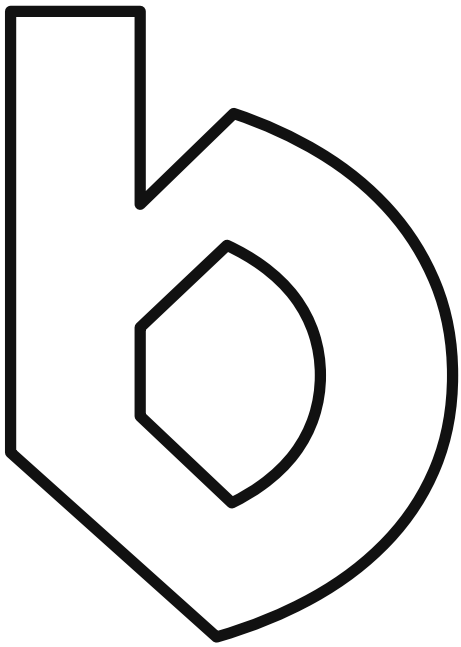
bow (and arrow)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱹᱯ ᱡᱷ

᱾ ᱾ ᱾ ᱾

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NAME · ᱟᱦᱚᱠ

ᱚᱠ

ahk

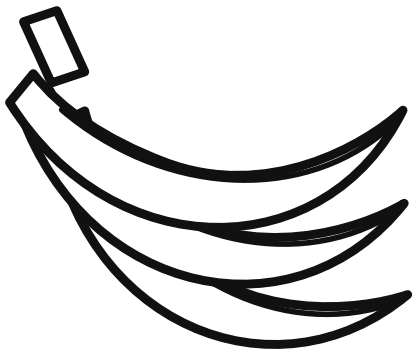
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱠ — ᱚᱠ

Its name is «aak». Row 2: ᱚ ᱠ ᱡ ᱢ ᱭ



ᱠ IS FOR

ᱠᱟᱨᱟᱦ

KAI-rah

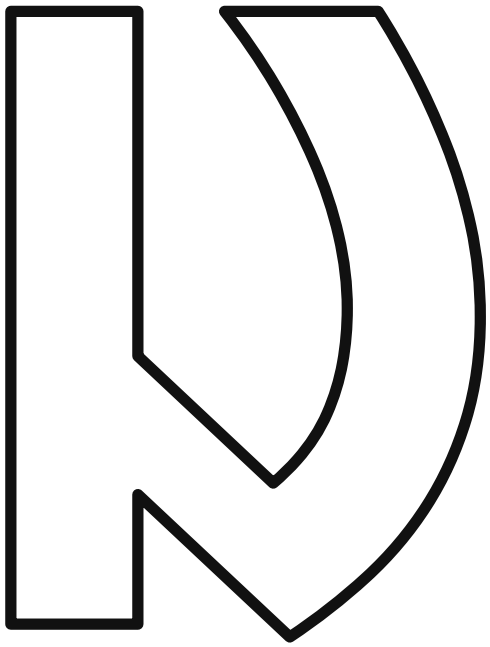
banana

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱢᱫ

ᱠ ᱠ ᱠ ᱠ

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NAME · ᱟᱦᱡ

ᱚᱣ

ahj

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

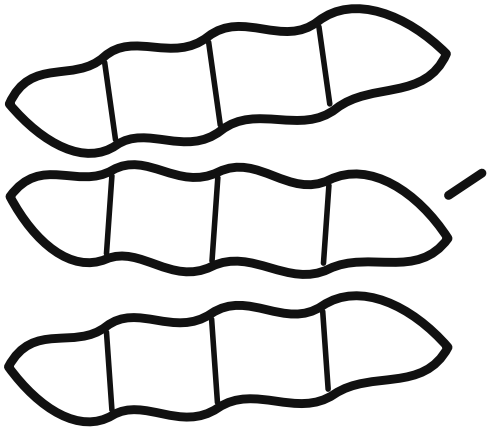
‘j’ as in “jam”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱣ — ᱚᱣ

Its name is «aaj». Row 2: ᱚ ᱦ ᱣ ᱩ ᱭ

At the end of a word ᱣ is a “caught” sound: the mouth closes but no air comes out (ᱚᱠᱦᱣ tookooch’ “pot”).



ᱣ IS FOR

ᱡᱚᱡᱚ

JAW-jaw

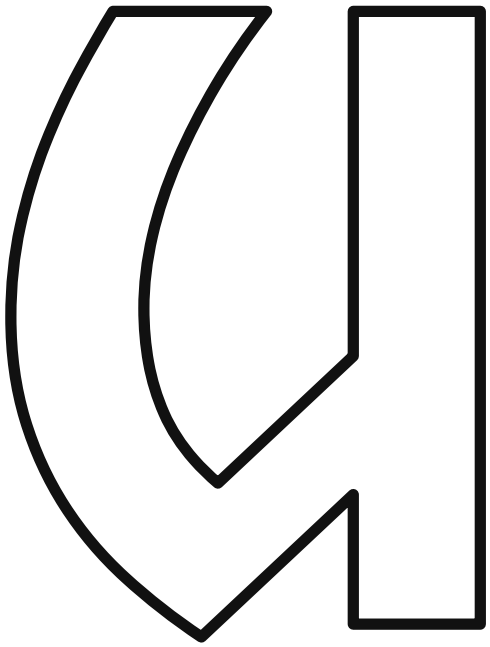
tamarind

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱩᱱ

ᱣ ᱣ ᱣ ᱣ

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NAME · ᱟᱦᱚᱱᱟ

ᱚᱟ

ahm

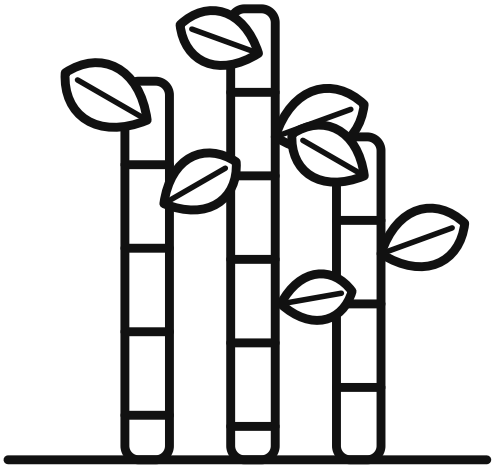
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱟ — ᱚᱟ

Its name is «aam». Row 2: ᱚ ᱦ ᱱ ᱟ ᱭ



ᱟ IS FOR

ᱢᱟᱛ

maht

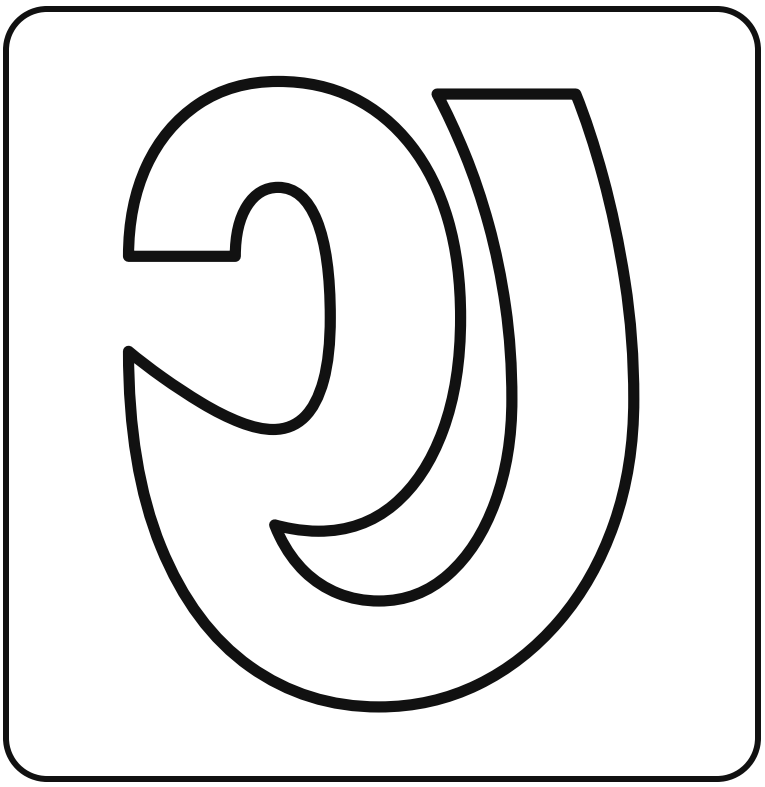
bamboo

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱨ ᱩᱮ

ᱟ ᱟ ᱟ ᱟ

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NAME · ᱟᱦᱣ

ᱟᱣ

ahw

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘w’ as in “water”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱣ — ᱟᱣ

Its name is «aaw». Row 2: ᱟ ᱠ ᱡ ᱢ ᱣ

Find ᱣ in the middle of ᱪᱟᱦᱣᱯᱟ!



ᱣ IS FOR

ᱪᱟᱦᱣᱯᱟ

CHAHW-leh

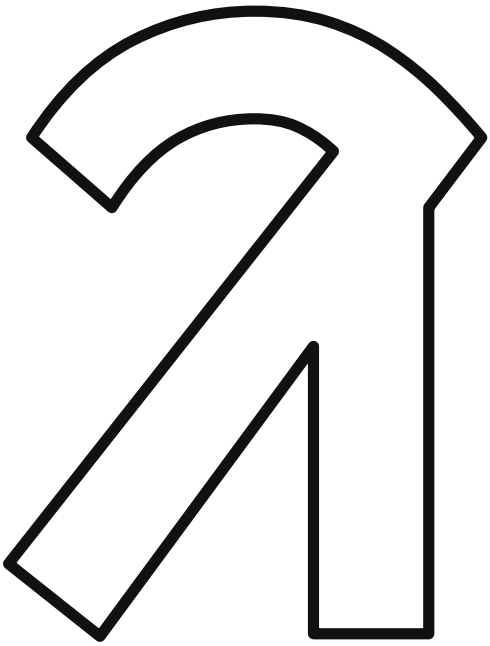
rice (the grain)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱢᱟ

ᱣ ᱣ ᱣ ᱣ

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NAME · ᱯᱚᱲᱛ

ᱯᱭ

lee

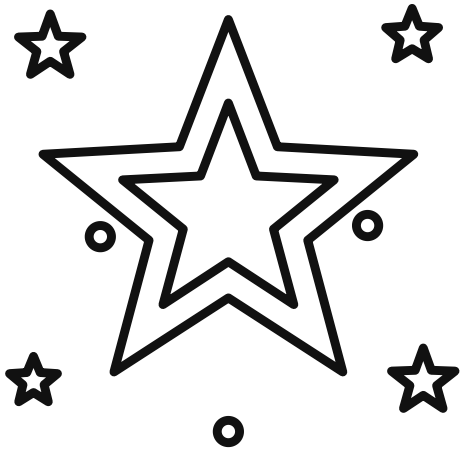
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ee’ as in “see”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱭ — ᱯᱭ

Its name is «li». Row 3: ᱭ ᱸ ᱹ ᱺ ᱻ



ᱭ IS FOR

ᱭᱩᱭᱯ

EE-peel

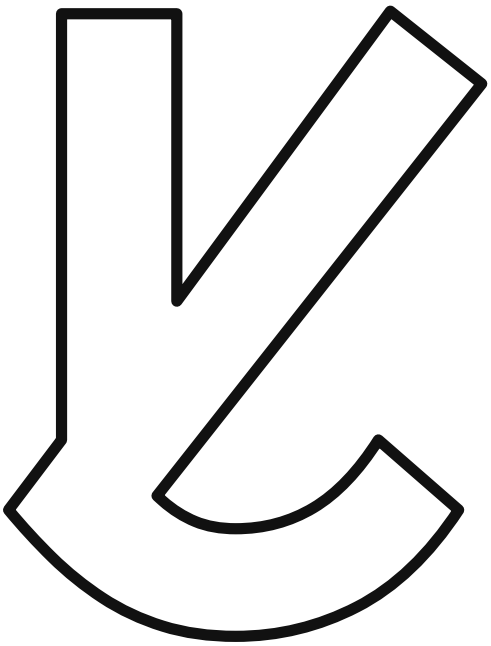
star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱩᱸ

ᱭ ᱭ ᱭ ᱭ

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NAME · ᱢᱮᱥᱟᱹ

ᱥᱮ

ees

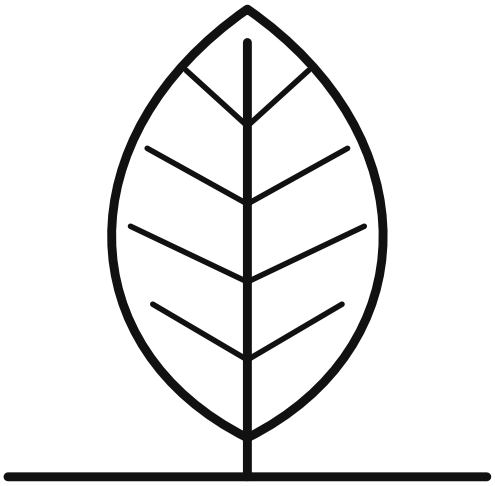
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱮ — ᱥᱮ

Its name is «is». Row 3: ᱥ ᱮ ᱣ ᱩ ᱭ



ᱮ IS FOR

ᱮᱦᱚᱦᱟᱹ

SAH-kahm

leaf

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱩᱪ

ᱮ ᱮ ᱮ ᱮ

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NAME · ᱫᱚᱦᱚ

ᱨᱜ

eeh

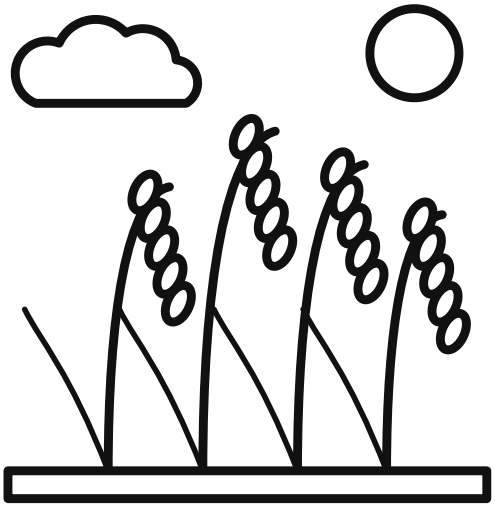
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱜ — ᱨᱜ

Its name is «ih». Row 3: ᱨ ᱤ ᱜ ᱧ ᱲ



ᱜ IS FOR

ᱜᱚᱞᱚ

HAW-raw

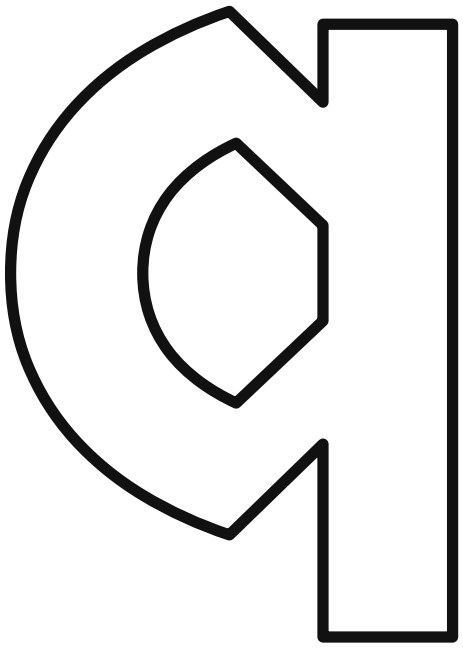
paddy (rice plant)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱩᱸ

ᱜ ᱜ ᱜ ᱜ

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NAME · ᱱᱮᱱᱭ

ᱛᱱ

eeny

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ny’ as in “canyon”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱱ — ᱛᱱ

Its name is «iny». Row 3: ᱛ ᱜ ᱣ ᱱ ᱯ



ᱱ IS FOR

ᱱᱟᱦᱚᱸ ᱫᱷᱸᱚᱜ

NYEE-dah CHAHN-daw

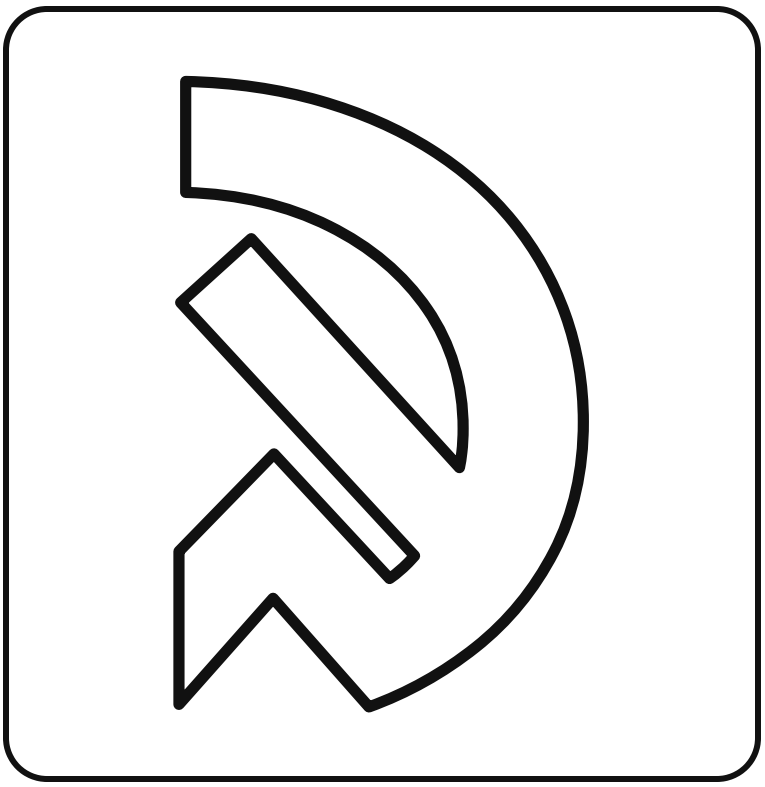
moon (“night sun”)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱩᱨ

ᱱ ᱱ ᱱ ᱱ

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NAME · ᱨᱮᱱᱩ

ᱨᱮ

eer

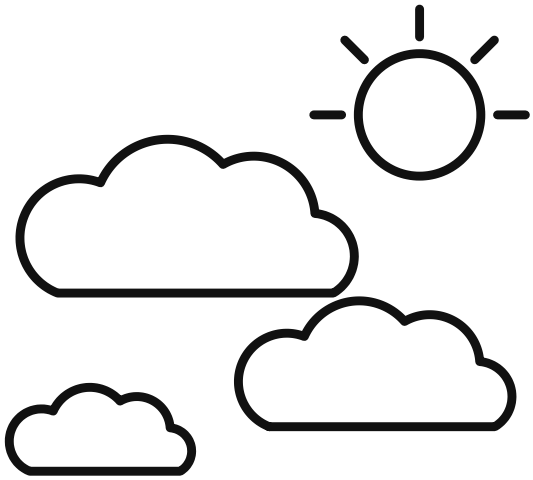
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a tapped ‘r’

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱮ — ᱨᱮ

Its name is «ir». Row 3: ᱨ ᱵ ᱡ ᱩ ᱮ



ᱮ IS FOR

ᱮᱨᱩᱨᱯ

REE-meel

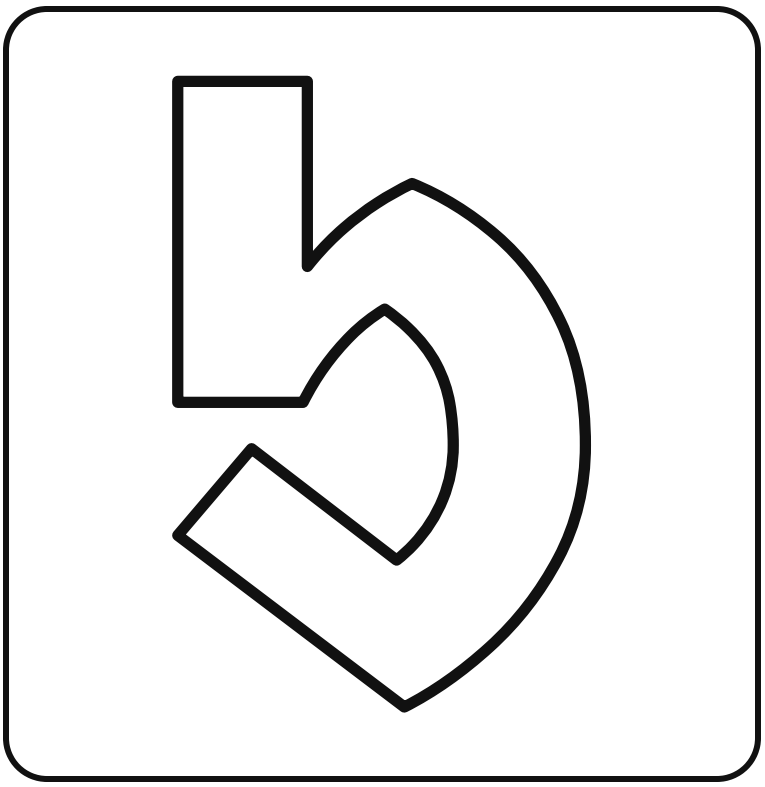
cloud

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱩᱨ



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NAME · ᱯᱩᱞᱩ

ᱯᱩ

loo

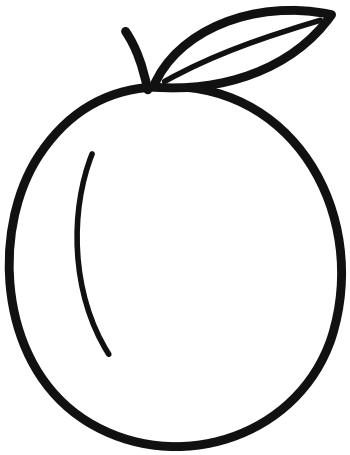
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘oo’ as in “moon”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱩ — ᱯᱩ

Its name is «lu». Row 4: ᱩ ᱭ ᱰ ᱢ ᱣ



ᱩ IS FOR

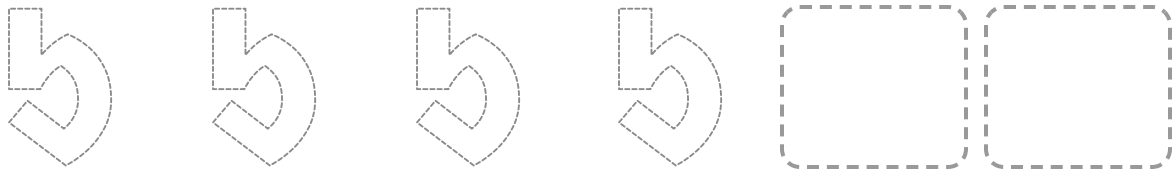
ᱩᱯ

ool

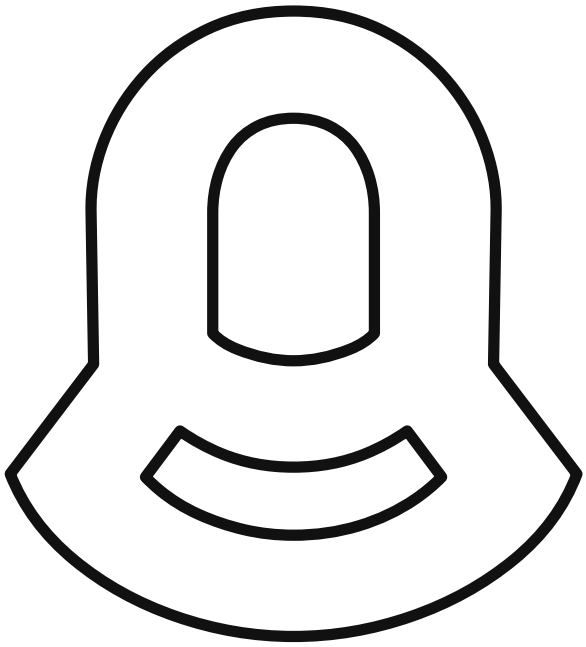
mango

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱩᱯ



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NAME · ᱢᱚᱪᱩ

ᱪᱩ

ooch

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

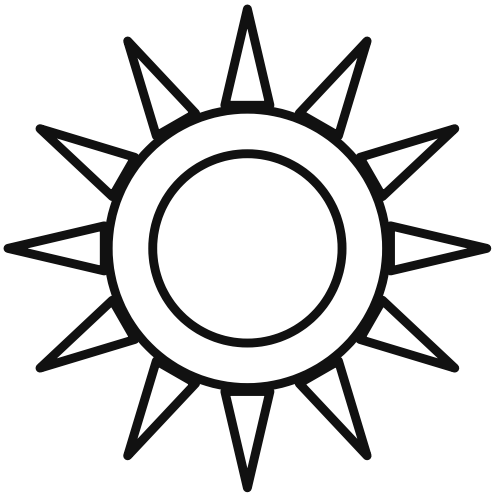
‘ch’ as in “chair”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱚ — ᱪᱩ

Its name is «uch». Row 4: ᱪ ᱚ ᱛ ᱣ ᱫ

The little mark ᱹ makes the vowel before it hum through the nose: ᱥᱸ «chahn».



ᱥ IS FOR

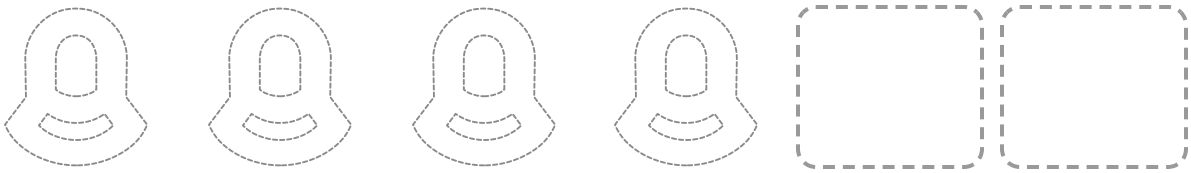
ᱥᱸᱫᱟᱣ

CHAHN-daw

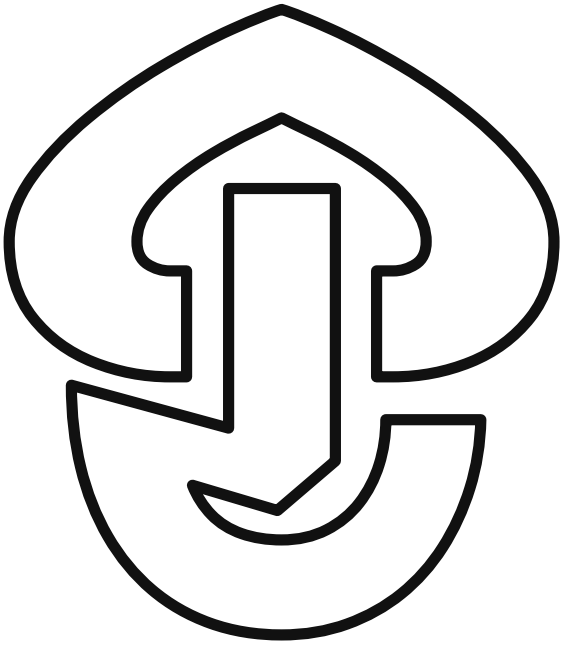
sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱵᱞ ᱩᱨ



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NAME · ᱫᱚᱫᱽ

ᱚᱰ

ood

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

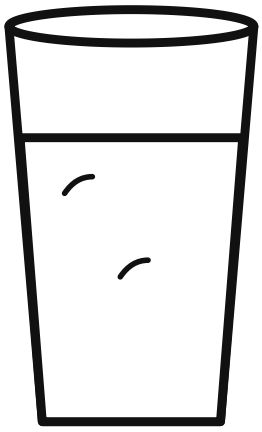
‘d’ as in “day”, with the tongue on the teeth

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱰ — ᱚᱰ

Its name is «ud». Row 4: ᱚ ᱤ ᱰ ᱣ ᱛ

At the end of a word ᱰ is a “caught” sound: the mouth closes but no air comes out (ᱢᱟᱦᱰ maht’ “bamboo”).



ᱰ IS FOR

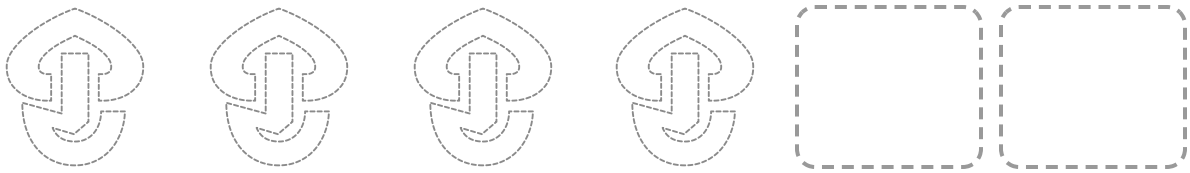
ᱫᱟᱦᱜ

dahk

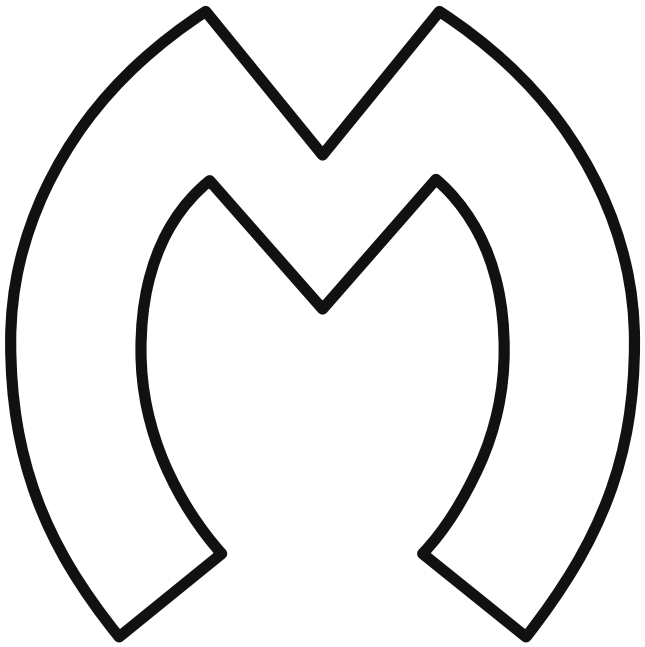
water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱨ ᱩᱥ



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NAME · ᱢᱚᱱ

ᱚᱢ

oon

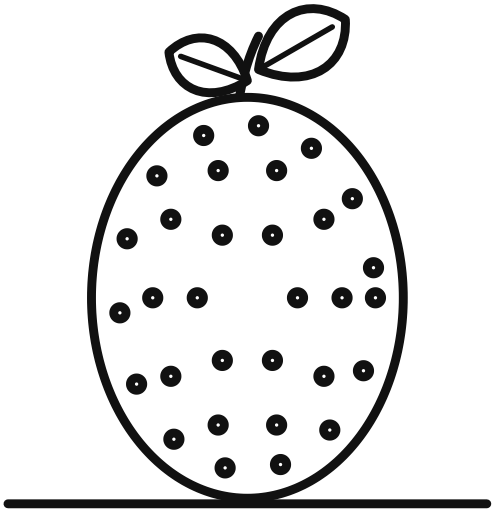
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

an ‘n’ with the tongue curled back

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱢ — ᱚᱢ

Its name is «unn». Row 4: ᱚ ᱛ ᱥ ᱢ ᱨ ᱢ never starts a word. Find it in the middle of ᱠᱟᱦᱱᱚᱲᱟᱹ! You also hear it in ᱣᱚᱢᱩ «mawneh», “five”.



ᱢ IS FOR

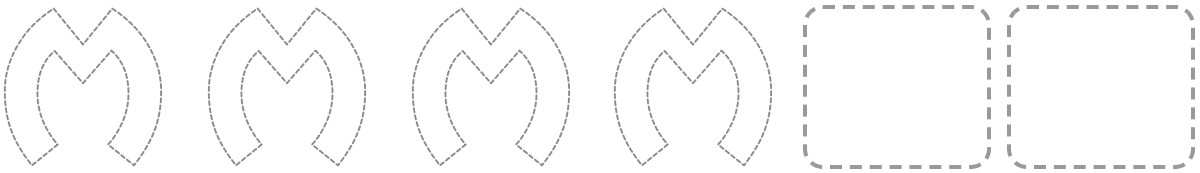
ᱠᱟᱦᱱᱚᱲᱟᱹ

KAHN-thahr

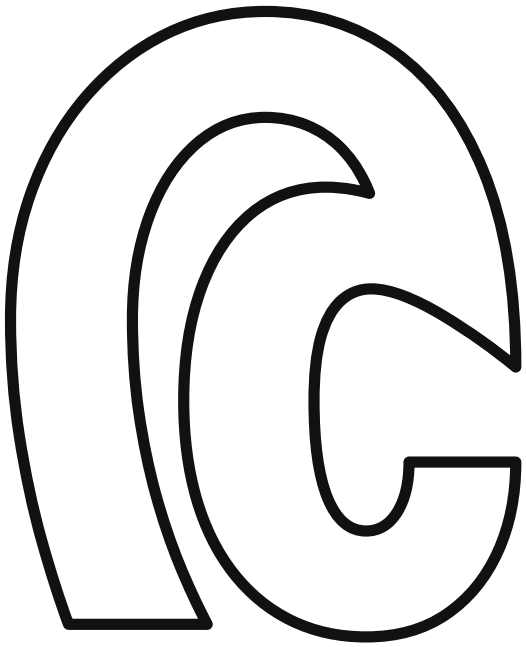
jackfruit

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱨ ᱩᱫ



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NAME · ᱫᱚᱣᱩ

ᱣᱮ

ooy

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

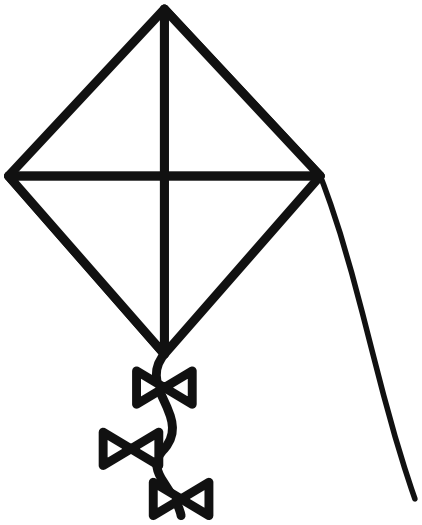
‘y’ as in “yes”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱮ — ᱣᱮ

Its name is «uy». Row 4: ᱣ ᱤ ᱧ ᱱ ᱮ

ᱮ rarely starts a word. Find it at the end of ᱡᱟᱮ!



ᱮ IS FOR

ᱡᱟᱮ

HAW-eh

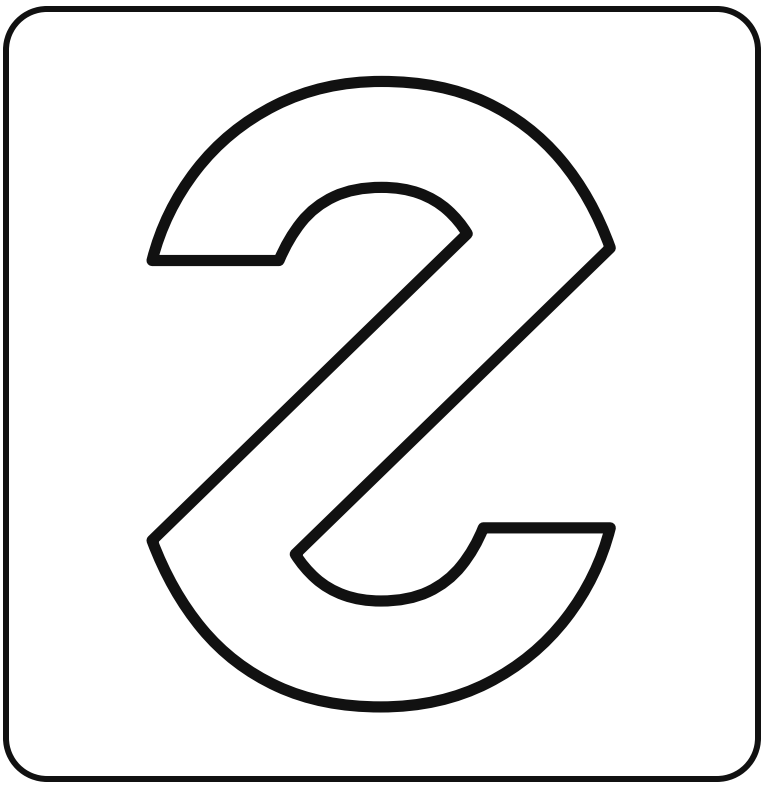
wind (good for flying a kite!)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱫᱚ ᱩᱥ

ᱮ ᱮ ᱮ ᱮ

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NAME · ᱢᱚᱞ

ᱯᱷ

leh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

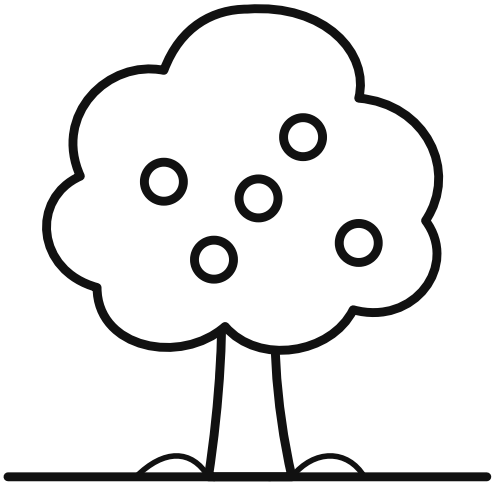
‘e’ as in “bed”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱷ — ᱯᱷ

Its name is «le». Row 5: ᱷ ᱸ ᱹ ᱺ ᱻ

Find **ᱷ** at the end of ᱛᱟᱨᱮᱷ!



ᱷ IS FOR

ᱛᱟᱨᱮᱷ

DAH-reh

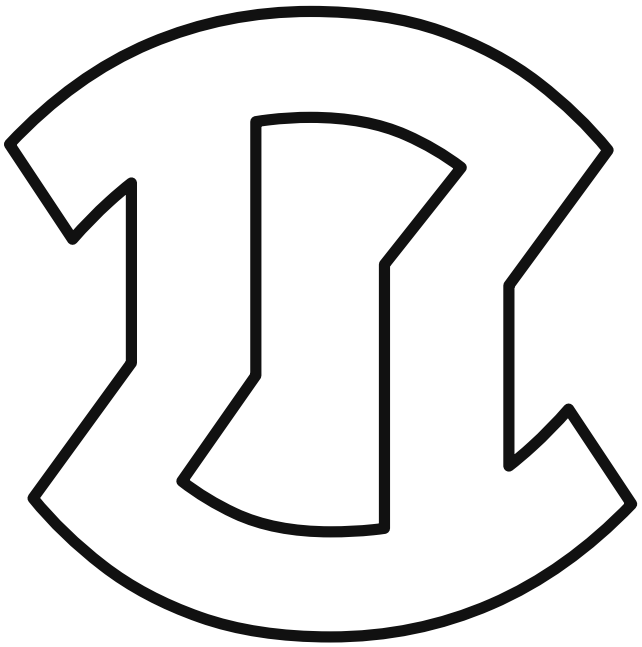
tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱡᱷ

ᱷ ᱷ ᱷ ᱷ

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NAME · ᱫᱷᱚᱠᱤ

ᱫᱷ

ehp

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

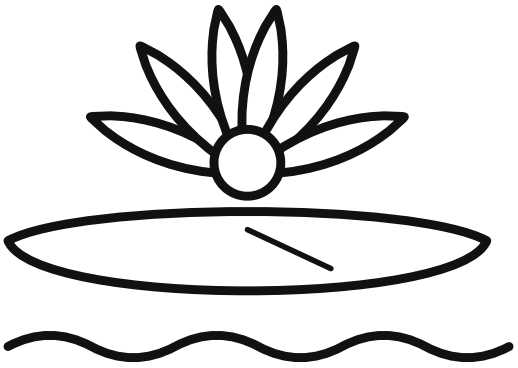
‘p’ as in “pen”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱚ — ᱫᱷ

Its name is «ep». Row 5: ᱫ ᱚ ᱛ ᱜ ᱡ

ᱚ IS FOR



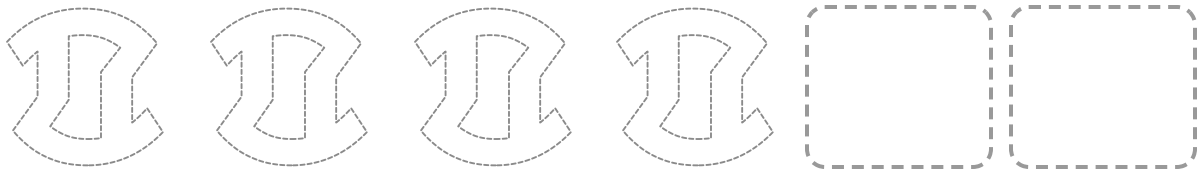
ᱯᱷᱩᱠᱩᱨᱤ

POOKH-ree

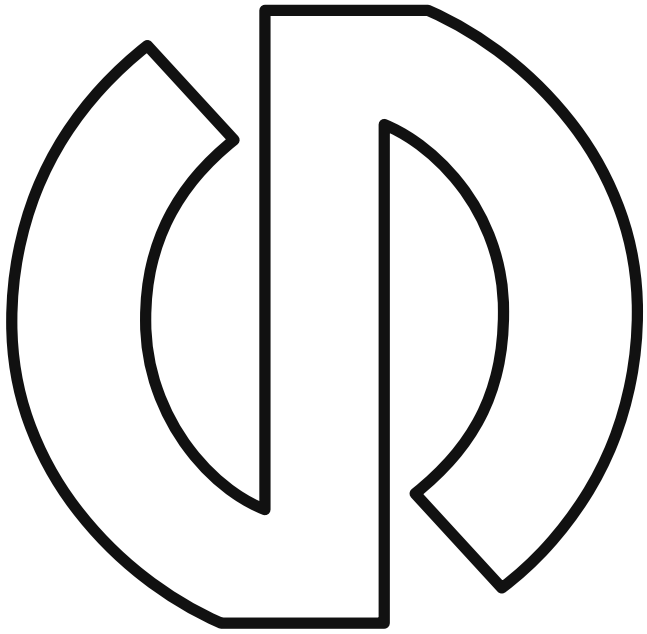
pond

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱭᱯ ᱩᱫ



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NAME · ᱫᱚᱞᱛᱟ

ᱛᱚ

ehd

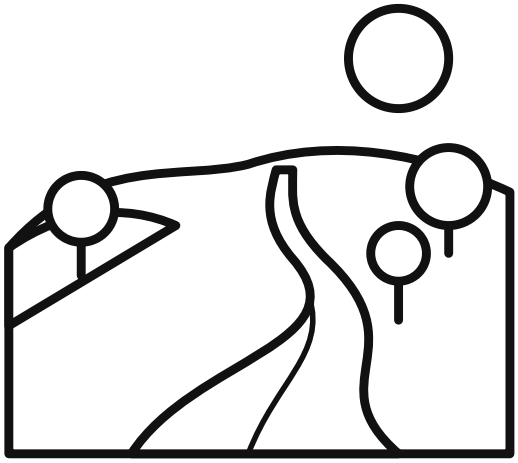
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a ‘d’ with the tongue curled back

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱚ — ᱛᱚ

Its name is «edd». Row 5: ᱛ ᱢ ᱚ ᱣ ᱡ



ᱚ IS FOR

ᱚᱦᱟᱨ

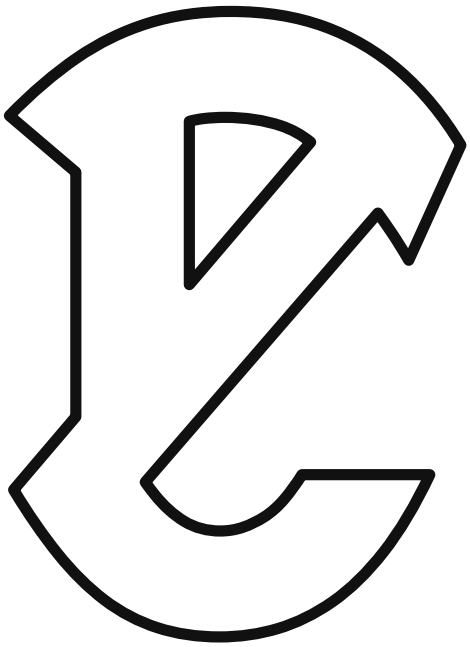
DAH-hahr

path, road

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱨ ᱩᱛ

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NAME · ᱫᱚᱱᱩ

ᱫᱮ

ehn

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

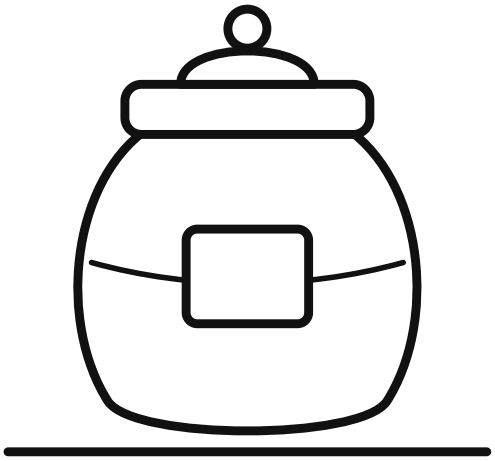
‘n’ as in “net”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱮ — ᱫᱮ

Its name is «en». Row 5: ᱫ ᱣ ᱦ ᱮ ᱡ

Find ᱮ in the middle of ᱦᱚᱮᱚᱩ!



ᱮ IS FOR

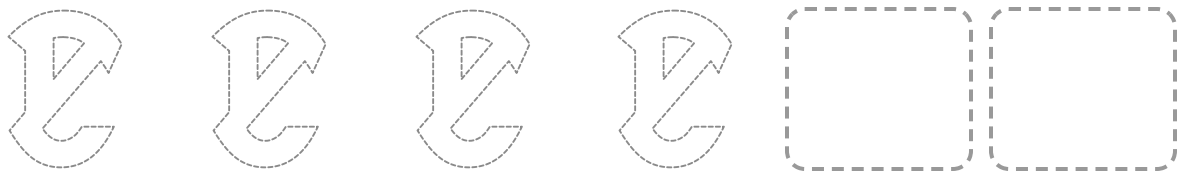
ᱦᱚᱮᱚᱩ

SOO-noom

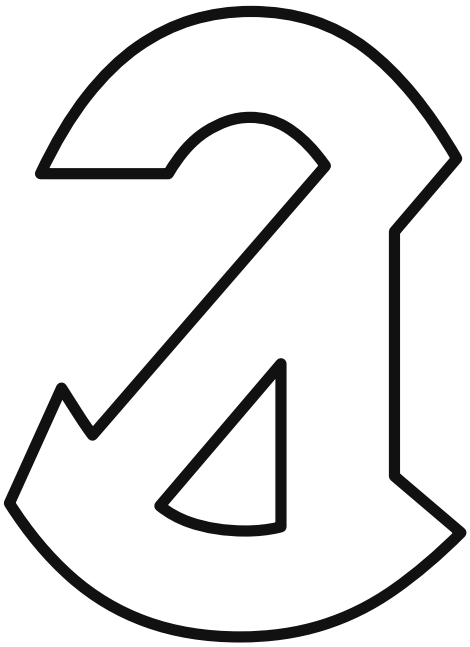
oil

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱨ ᱩᱫ



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NAME · ᱨᱚᱦᱟ

ᱨᱟ

ehr

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

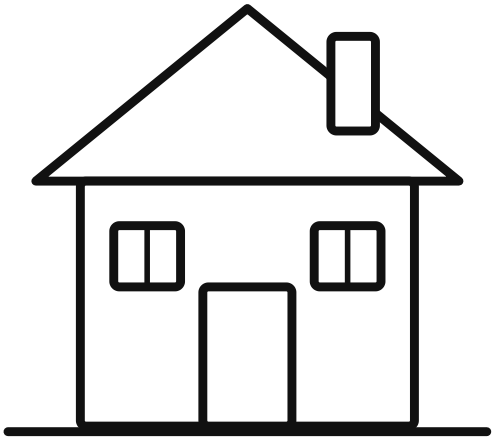
a flapped ‘r’ with the tongue curled back

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱚ — ᱨᱟ

Its name is «err». Row 5: ᱨ ᱩ ᱮ ᱭ ᱚ

ᱟ never starts a word. Find it in the middle of ᱚᱞᱟᱜ!



ᱟ IS FOR

ᱚᱞᱟᱜ

AW-rahk

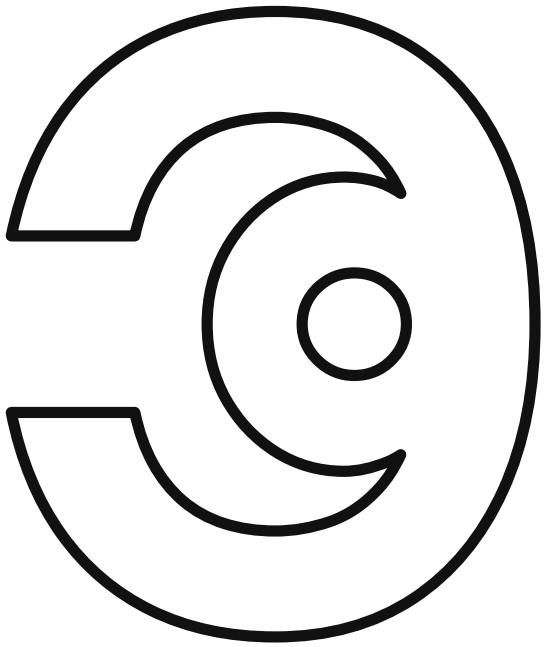
house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱨ ᱩᱨ

ᱟ ᱟ ᱟ ᱟ

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NAME · ᱯᱚᱞᱚᱦ

ᱯᱚ

loh

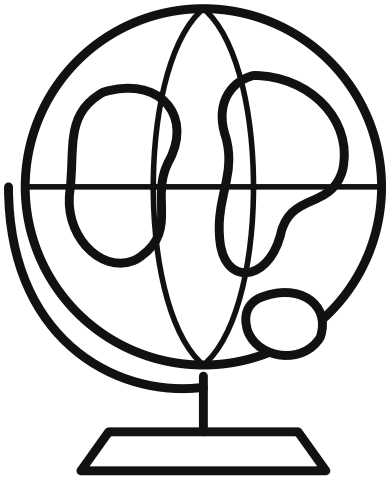
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘o’ as in “go” (short and pure)

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱚ — ᱯᱚ

Its name is «lo». Row 6: ᱚ ᱦ ᱧ ᱬ ᱭ



ᱚ IS FOR

ᱚᱣᱟ

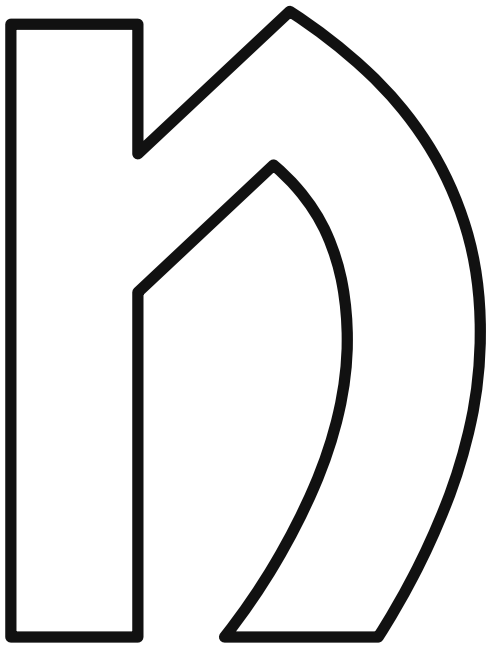
OH-teh

land, the earth

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱩᱟ

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NAME · ᱚᱦᱚᱫ

ᱚᱦ

oht

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a ‘t’ with the tongue curled back

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱦ — ᱚᱦ

Its name is «ott». Row 6: ᱚ ᱦ ᱛ ᱡ ᱳ

Find ᱦ in the middle of ᱯᱚᱦᱟ!



ᱦ IS FOR

ᱯᱚᱦᱟ

LAW-tah

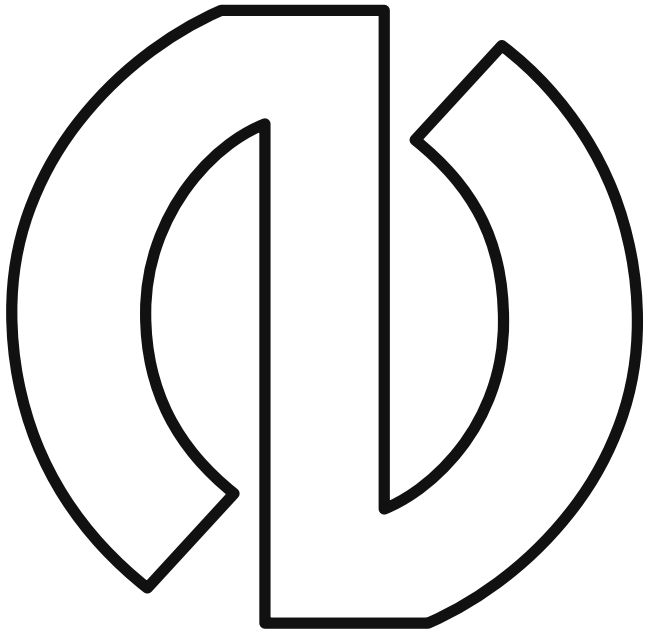
water jug (lota)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱯ ᱩᱨ

ᱦ ᱦ ᱦ ᱦ

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NAME · ᱫᱚᱦᱚ

ᱚᱲ

ohb

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

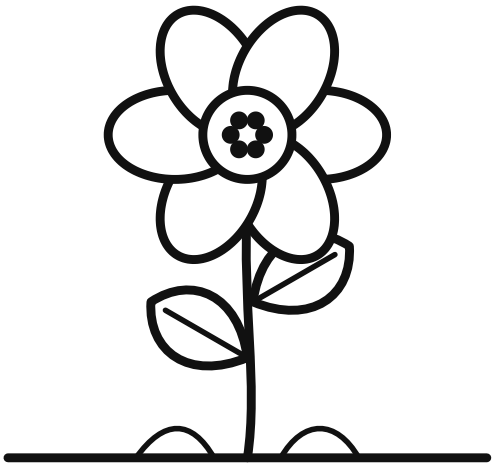
‘b’ as in “ball”

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱲ — ᱚᱲ

Its name is «ob». Row 6: ᱚ ᱣ ᱲ ᱭ ᱯ

At the end of a word ᱲ is a “caught” sound: the mouth closes but no air comes out (ᱥᱟᱦᱲ sahp’ “catch”).



ᱲ IS FOR

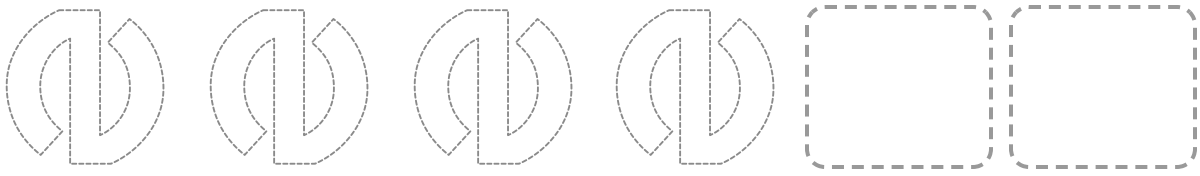
ᱵᱟᱦᱟ

BAH-hah

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱚᱨ ᱩᱨ



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ᱣᱳ

NAME · ᱢᱚᱱᱚᱨ

ᱣᱳ

ohw

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a ‘w’ hummed through the nose

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱣᱳ — ᱡᱣᱳ

Its name is «ov». Row 6: ᱡ ᱢ ᱤ ᱣᱳ ᱱ

ᱣᱳ never starts a word. Find it in the middle of ᱦᱟᱣᱦᱮᱫ! It is also in ᱱᱚᱣᱟᱦ «nawah», “this”.



ᱣᱳ IS FOR

ᱦᱟᱣᱦᱮᱫ

SAHW-hehd

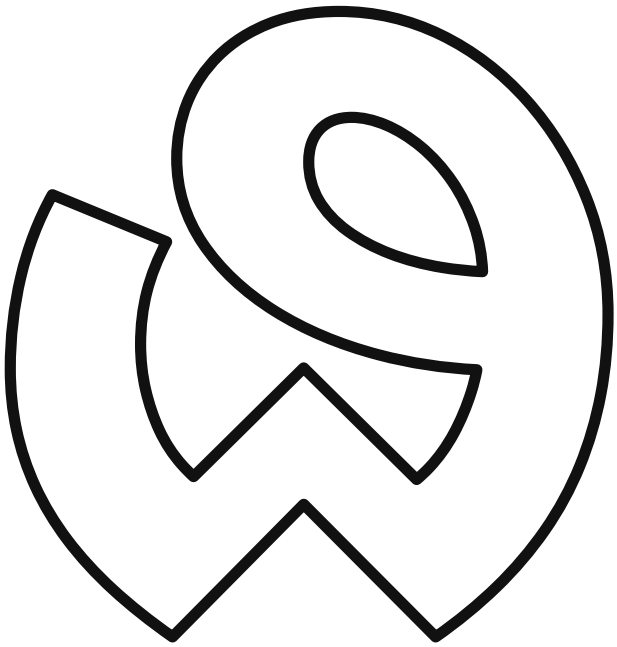
stories and books (literature)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱡᱯ ᱩᱨ

ᱣᱳ ᱣᱳ ᱣᱳ ᱣᱳ

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NAME · ᱫᱷᱚᱦᱩ

ᱚᱲ

ohh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a puff of breath after the letter before it

OL CHIKI NAME · ITS ROW

ᱲ — ᱚᱲ

Its name is «oh». Row 6: ᱚ ᱦ ᱡ ᱭ ᱲ

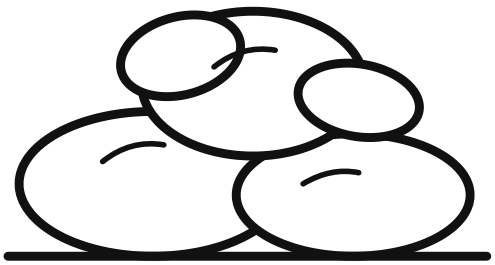
ᱲ never starts a word. It adds a puff of air: ᱫ + ᱲ = ᱫᱲ «dh», as in ᱫᱲᱨᱮ.

ᱲ IS FOR

ᱫᱷᱮᱨᱮ

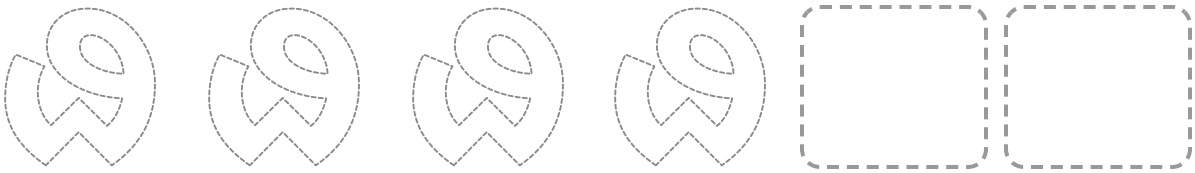
DHEE-ree

stone



Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ᱵᱞ ᱡᱷ

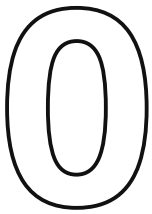


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BONUS

Santali numbers ᱥᱟ ᱦᱚ *(EHL kaw)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Santali: *soon*, *mit'*, *bahr*, *peh*...

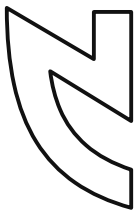


0

ᱨᱮᱫ

soon

zero



1

ᱢᱤᱫ

mit'

one



2

ᱯᱟᱦ

bahr

two



3

ᱯᱮ

peh

three



4

ᱯᱩᱱ

poon

four



5

ᱢᱟᱣᱱ

MAWN-eh

five

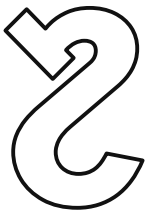


6

ᱚᱹᱨᱩᱭ

TOO-rooy

six

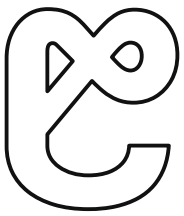


7

ᱮᱞᱟᱦ

EH-yahy

seven

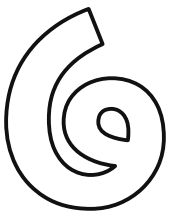


8

ᱨᱮᱢ.ᱯ

EE-rul

eight



9

ᱟᱨᱮ

AH-reh

nine

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LET'S TALK

My first Santali words ᱚᱱᱟᱹᱠ ᱚᱰᱟ

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

ᱥᱟᱞᱟᱢᱩ ᱟᱞᱟᱭᱠᱩᱢ

as-sah-LAH-moo ah-LAI-koom
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

ᱡᱚ ᱟᱞᱟᱭᱠᱩᱢ ᱥᱟᱞᱟᱢᱩ

wa ah-LAI-koom as-sah-LAHM
And upon you be peace (the reply)

ᱡᱚᱦᱟᱨ!

JAW-hahr
Hello! (the Santali greeting)

ᱮᱱᱟᱜ ᱧᱩᱛᱩᱢ …

EE-nyahk NYOO-toom …
My name is …

ᱥᱟᱦᱟᱨᱦᱚᱣ

SAHR-hahw
Thank you

ᱡᱟᱡᱟᱞᱠᱟᱞᱞᱟᱦᱩ ᱠᱷᱟᱭᱨᱟᱱ

jah-zah-kahl-LAH-hoo KHAI-rahn
May Allah reward you with good

ᱟᱭᱚ · ᱵᱟᱵᱟ

AH-yoh · BAH-bah
Mother · Father

ᱫᱟᱫᱟ · ᱫᱮᱭ

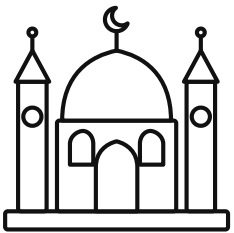
DAH-dah · dai
Big brother · Big sister

ᱦᱮᱸ · ᱵᱟᱦᱸᱜ

hen · bahng
Yes · No

ᱮᱱᱟ ᱥᱟᱦᱨᱚᱱᱴᱟᱨ ᱪᱮᱫ.ᱮᱞᱟ ᱫᱚᱱ ᱪᱮᱫᱟ!

eeny SAHN-tah-ree PAR-see chehd EH-dahny
I am learning Santali!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

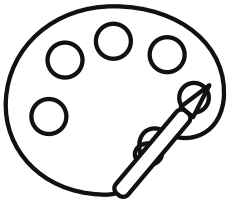
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International) and the Census of India.

What's next?
You have met all **30 Santali letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Santali, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ᱢᱟᱦᱟᱱᱯᱟᱞᱞᱟᱦ! ᱵᱮᱦᱮᱞ ᱜᱮᱫ!

MAH-shah-lah! behs geh! — Mashallah! Well done!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 30 letters of the Santali alphabet.

_____ Date

_____ Grown-up's signature

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.